Interpreting the pipeline

Complete text version

Inspect a fictional CRM snapshot and build a short pipeline review. Separate active opportunities from closed outcomes, compare time in stage, then use deal values and expected close dates to explain one strength and one risk.

This is ungraded practice. The checks compare your selections and counts with the displayed data; your optional written notes are for your own reflection. Your work and checked attempts are saved automatically in this browser. Return here to resume; Restart clears saved work and attempts for this activity. Nothing is submitted. Download your review if you want to keep it.

Definitions and snapshot

The snapshot is fixed at 19 August 2025. Days in stage and expected close dates belong to that fictional snapshot.

Prospect, Qualify, Discover, Propose and Close describe active sales work. Nurture describes work with an existing customer. Closed Won and Closed Lost are recorded outcomes. This snapshot has no active records labelled Propose, Close or Nurture.

Compare time in stage with peers at the same stage. An outlier is a reason to investigate, not proof of a stalled or lost deal. No stage-duration target is supplied.

A snapshot shows current distribution. It does not show how many deals moved between stages over a period, so it cannot establish a conversion rate or steady progression.

Deal values use a common monetary unit. An expected close date is an estimate; potential deal value is not guaranteed revenue. Exclude closed outcomes when reviewing active opportunities.

Use the text version

Use the full record list below for each review. Group active and closed records, order active records by days in stage or value, and compare expected dates. Write your counts, selections and optional interpretations on paper or in a text file before reading feedback. In the interaction, you can filter and sort this same dataset, then check and explicitly complete each review. Changing a selection invalidates its earlier check and completion. After two unsuccessful checks, an optional worked review fills the supported selections; you still choose Complete this review. The downloaded record distinguishes worked reviews from checked selections. Answers show green Correct or red Try again labels and explanations. Correct, check and complete each review to unlock the next; navigation cannot skip it. Changed answers lock later reviews again. The final record distinguishes Correct and Worked answer. Nothing advances automatically.

Record views: All records; Active only; Closed outcomes; Prospect; Qualify; Discover; Propose; Close; Nurture. Sort choices: Record ID; Days in stage: highest first; Deal value: highest first; Expected close: earliest first. A view with no matching rows says No records in this view. Each view reports its count and sum of recorded deal values; a view containing only active rows labels this as Active potential deal value. An expandable stage-count list reports the count in every stage/outcome. Count and total for closed records describe that selected group, not future active revenue.

CRM records: fictional snapshot at 19 August 2025

- A-001 | Jin Cloud Solutions | Current stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 4 | Deal value: 27,330 monetary units | Expected close date: 3 October 2025.
- A-002 | Ordinary Systems | Current stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 6 | Deal value: 14,778 monetary units | Expected close date: 28 September 2025.
- A-003 | Solitude Innovations | Current stage: Discover | Days in stage: 7 | Deal value: 16,351 monetary units | Expected close date: 23 September 2025.
- A-004 | Patternmaster Strategies | Current stage: Closed Won | Days in stage: 7 | Deal value: 10,899 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- A-005 | Carrow and Vale Consulting | Current stage: Closed Won | Days in stage: 6 | Deal value: 31,277 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- B-001 | Ashbourne Global | Current stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 4 | Deal value: 12,507 monetary units | Expected close date: 3 October 2025.
- B-002 | Anarres Systems | Current stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 22 | Deal value: 46,071 monetary units | Expected close date: 28 September 2025.
- B-003 | Port Coriol Labs | Current stage: Discover | Days in stage: 9 | Deal value: 21,346 monetary units | Expected close date: 23 September 2025.
- B-004 | Lancre Works | Current stage: Closed Won | Days in stage: 8 | Deal value: 37,769 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.

- B-005 | Dawnstar Diagnostics | Current stage: Closed Lost | Days in stage: 9 | Deal value: 32,220 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- C-001 | Primer Systems | Current stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 8 | Deal value: 36,059 monetary units | Expected close date: 3 October 2025.
- C-002 | Makeda MedTech | Current stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 7 | Deal value: 29,689 monetary units | Expected close date: 28 September 2025.
- C-003 | Karhide Consulting Group | Current stage: Discover | Days in stage: 12 | Deal value: 12,871 monetary units | Expected close date: 23 September 2025.
- C-004 | Olamina Advisory | Current stage: Closed Lost | Days in stage: 14 | Deal value: 30,219 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- C-005 | Vetinari Investments | Current stage: Closed Won | Days in stage: 12 | Deal value: 13,372 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- D-001 | Klatch Mercantile | Current stage: Prospect | Days in stage: 15 | Deal value: 37,088 monetary units | Expected close date: 3 October 2025.
- D-002 | Sto Lat Select | Current stage: Qualify | Days in stage: 13 | Deal value: 21,548 monetary units | Expected close date: 28 September 2025.
- D-003 | Silverpath Outfitters | Current stage: Discover | Days in stage: 13 | Deal value: 30,904 monetary units | Expected close date: 23 September 2025.
- D-004 | Laconia Energy Systems | Current stage: Closed Won | Days in stage: 2 | Deal value: 25,491 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.
- D-005 | Idiran Dynamics | Current stage: Closed Lost | Days in stage: 6 | Deal value: 49,307 monetary units | Expected close date: 24 August 2025.

Separate active and closed records

Compare All records with Active only. Count the active opportunities and closed outcomes, then choose a conclusion the snapshot supports.

Choose before reading feedback

Number of active opportunities

Enter a whole-number count from 0 to 20.

Number of closed outcomes

Enter a whole-number count from 0 to 20.

What does the distribution establish?

- Active records are equally split across three stages; movement over time is not shown.
- Equal stage counts prove that deals are moving at a steady rate.
- All 20 records are future sales opportunities.

- No active Close records means no deals have ever been won.

Your interpretation (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Number of active opportunities

Supported count: 12. There are 12 active opportunities: four in Prospect, four in Qualify and four in Discover.

If the count differs: Count Prospect, Qualify and Discover records. Keep Closed Won and Closed Lost in the separate closed-outcome count.

Number of closed outcomes

Supported count: 8. There are eight closed outcomes: five Closed Won and three Closed Lost.

If the count differs: Count both Closed Won and Closed Lost. Neither category belongs in the active-opportunity count.

What does the distribution establish?

Active records are equally split across three stages; movement over time is not shown. Four active records sit in each of Prospect, Qualify and Discover. Equal current counts do not show how deals moved or converted over time.

Equal stage counts prove that deals are moving at a steady rate. Current counts do not reveal movement over a period. You would need dated stage changes or a defined cohort to support that claim.

All 20 records are future sales opportunities. Eight records already have closed outcomes. Including them as active opportunities overstates the current pipeline.

No active Close records means no deals have ever been won. The Closed Won outcomes show recorded wins. An empty active Close work stage does not erase those outcomes.

Worked review

Number of active opportunities: 12

Number of closed outcomes: 8

What does the distribution establish?: Active records are equally split across three stages; movement over time is not shown.

Investigate time in stage

Compare all four qualification records. Select the record that has spent longest in that stage and decide what the difference warrants.

Choose before reading feedback

Which qualification record needs a closer timing review?

- A-001 · Jin Cloud Solutions · Prospect · 4 days · 27,330
- A-002 · Ordinary Systems · Qualify · 6 days · 14,778
- A-003 · Solitude Innovations · Discover · 7 days · 16,351
- B-001 · Ashbourne Global · Prospect · 4 days · 12,507
- B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071
- B-003 · Port Coriol Labs · Discover · 9 days · 21,346
- C-001 · Primer Systems · Prospect · 8 days · 36,059
- C-002 · Makeda MedTech · Qualify · 7 days · 29,689
- C-003 · Karhide Consulting Group · Discover · 12 days · 12,871
- D-001 · Klatch Mercantile · Prospect · 15 days · 37,088
- D-002 · Sto Lat Select · Qualify · 13 days · 21,548
- D-003 · Silverpath Outfitters · Discover · 13 days · 30,904

What can you conclude from the timing?

- Review the outlier's notes and agreed next step before deciding whether progress has stalled.
- The longest qualification record must be marked Closed Lost.
- Every qualification record above ten days has breached the stage target.
- Ignore timing because the four qualification records have the same stage.

Your interpretation (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Which qualification record needs a closer timing review?

A-001 · Jin Cloud Solutions · Prospect · 4 days · 27,330 A-001 has 4 days in Prospect. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

A-002 · Ordinary Systems · Qualify · 6 days · 14,778 A-002 has 6 days in Qualify. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

A-003 · Solitude Innovations · Discover · 7 days · 16,351 A-003 has 7 days in Discover. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

B-001 · Ashbourne Global · Prospect · 4 days · 12,507 B-001 has 4 days in Prospect. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071 B-002 has 22 days in Qualify; the other qualification records have 6, 7 and 13 days.

B-003 · Port Coriol Labs · Discover · 9 days · 21,346 B-003 has 9 days in Discover. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

C-001 · Primer Systems · Prospect · 8 days · 36,059 C-001 has 8 days in Prospect. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

C-002 · Makeda MedTech · Qualify · 7 days · 29,689 C-002 has 7 days in Qualify. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

C-003 · Karhide Consulting Group · Discover · 12 days · 12,871 C-003 has 12 days in Discover. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

D-001 · Klatch Mercantile · Prospect · 15 days · 37,088 D-001 has 15 days in Prospect. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

D-002 · Sto Lat Select · Qualify · 13 days · 21,548 D-002 has 13 days in Qualify. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

D-003 · Silverpath Outfitters · Discover · 13 days · 30,904 D-003 has 13 days in Discover. Compare all four qualification records to find the longest time within that stage.

What can you conclude from the timing?

Review the outlier's notes and agreed next step before deciding whether progress has stalled. B-002 has 22 days in Qualify; its peers have 6, 7 and 13. Investigate the difference. The snapshot provides no cause or agreed stage-duration target.

The longest qualification record must be marked Closed Lost. Time in stage alone does not establish a loss. A status change needs evidence about the opportunity's outcome.

Every qualification record above ten days has breached the stage target. No ten-day target is supplied. Compare the records without inventing a service level or stage-duration rule.

Ignore timing because the four qualification records have the same stage. Records in the same stage can have different timing risks. Comparing those peers is a useful starting point for investigation.

Worked review

Which qualification record needs a closer timing review?: B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071

What can you conclude from the timing?: Review the outlier's notes and agreed next step before deciding whether progress has stalled.

Put value and dates in context

Sort the active records by deal value, then by expected close date. Identify the largest active opportunity and the earliest expected active close date. Keep the closed outcomes separate.

Choose before reading feedback

Which active opportunity has the largest deal value?

- A-001 · Jin Cloud Solutions · Prospect · 4 days · 27,330
- A-002 · Ordinary Systems · Qualify · 6 days · 14,778
- A-003 · Solitude Innovations · Discover · 7 days · 16,351
- B-001 · Ashbourne Global · Prospect · 4 days · 12,507
- B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071
- B-003 · Port Coriol Labs · Discover · 9 days · 21,346
- C-001 · Primer Systems · Prospect · 8 days · 36,059
- C-002 · Makeda MedTech · Qualify · 7 days · 29,689
- C-003 · Karhide Consulting Group · Discover · 12 days · 12,871
- D-001 · Klatch Mercantile · Prospect · 15 days · 37,088
- D-002 · Sto Lat Select · Qualify · 13 days · 21,548
- D-003 · Silverpath Outfitters · Discover · 13 days · 30,904

Earliest expected close date among active opportunities

- 23 September 2025
- 28 September 2025
- 3 October 2025
- 24 August 2025

Which value-and-date interpretation is justified?

- Value helps size the opportunity; the timing outlier still needs investigation and close dates remain estimates.
- The largest deal value is guaranteed revenue on its expected close date.
- The 24 August dates on closed rows show new near-term active revenue.

- The largest value removes the need to review its time in stage.

Your interpretation (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

Which active opportunity has the largest deal value?

A-001 · Jin Cloud Solutions · Prospect · 4 days · 27,330 A-001 has 27,330 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

A-002 · Ordinary Systems · Qualify · 6 days · 14,778 A-002 has 14,778 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

A-003 · Solitude Innovations · Discover · 7 days · 16,351 A-003 has 16,351 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

B-001 · Ashbourne Global · Prospect · 4 days · 12,507 B-001 has 12,507 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071 B-002 has the largest active deal value: 46,071 monetary units.

B-003 · Port Coriol Labs · Discover · 9 days · 21,346 B-003 has 21,346 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

C-001 · Primer Systems · Prospect · 8 days · 36,059 C-001 has 36,059 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

C-002 · Makeda MedTech · Qualify · 7 days · 29,689 C-002 has 29,689 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

C-003 · Karhide Consulting Group · Discover · 12 days · 12,871 C-003 has 12,871 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

D-001 · Klatch Mercantile · Prospect · 15 days · 37,088 D-001 has 37,088 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

D-002 · Sto Lat Select · Qualify · 13 days · 21,548 D-002 has 21,548 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

D-003 · Silverpath Outfitters · Discover · 13 days · 30,904 D-003 has 30,904 monetary units of potential value. Another active record has a larger value; compare active rows without adding closed outcomes.

Earliest expected close date among active opportunities

23 September 2025 The four Discover records have expected close dates of 23 September. That is the earliest active date in the snapshot.

28 September 2025 Qualification records have this expected date, but the Discover records have an earlier one. Compare all active rows.

3 October 2025 Prospect records have this expected date. Other active records have earlier expected dates.

24 August 2025 This date appears on closed outcomes. Do not treat it as an active opportunity's expected future close.

Which value-and-date interpretation is justified?

Value helps size the opportunity; the timing outlier still needs investigation and close dates remain estimates. B-002 is the largest active record at 46,071 monetary units and is also the 22-day qualification outlier. Its 28 September expected close is an estimate, not a purchase commitment.

The largest deal value is guaranteed revenue on its expected close date. An active opportunity's value and expected date do not establish a commitment or a completed sale.

The 24 August dates on closed rows show new near-term active revenue. Those rows already have recorded outcomes. Their dates do not turn them back into active opportunities.

The largest value removes the need to review its time in stage. Value adds context to the timing concern. It does not explain why the opportunity has spent longer in qualification than its peers.

Worked review

Which active opportunity has the largest deal value?: B-002 · Anarres Systems · Qualify · 22 days · 46,071

Earliest expected close date among active opportunities: 23 September 2025

Which value-and-date interpretation is justified?: Value helps size the opportunity; the timing outlier still needs investigation and close dates remain estimates.

Write a supported pipeline review

Choose one supported strength and one supported risk. Add your own short interpretation if useful, then download the review with its data evidence.

Choose before reading feedback

A strength supported by the snapshot

- Twelve active opportunities provide coverage across Prospect, Qualify and Discover.
- Equal active counts prove a healthy conversion rate.
- All active deal value is committed revenue.
- Every closed outcome is a successful sale.

A risk supported by the snapshot

- B-002 combines the largest active value with unusually long qualification time and needs investigation.
- B-002 is already lost because it has 22 days in qualification.
- Every active opportunity is expected to close within five days of the snapshot.
- The pipeline contains no active opportunities.

Your interpretation (optional; not automatically assessed).

Feedback: compare after choosing

A strength supported by the snapshot

Twelve active opportunities provide coverage across Prospect, Qualify and Discover. The twelve active rows span three work stages. This describes coverage without claiming that the distribution proves healthy movement.

Equal active counts prove a healthy conversion rate. Current stage counts are not a conversion-rate denominator and do not show a time period or cohort.

All active deal value is committed revenue. The active rows represent potential opportunities. Their deal value does not establish a purchase commitment.

Every closed outcome is a successful sale. The closed group includes three Closed Lost records. Separate wins from losses.

A risk supported by the snapshot

B-002 combines the largest active value with unusually long qualification time and needs investigation. B-002 has 46,071 monetary units at stake and 22 days in qualification versus peer values of 6, 7 and 13 days. Review its context and next step before deciding the cause.

B-002 is already lost because it has 22 days in qualification. The record is still in Qualify. A time outlier is not evidence of a closed outcome.

Every active opportunity is expected to close within five days of the snapshot. The earliest active expected close is 23 September, 35 days after the 19 August snapshot. Five-day dates occur on closed records.

The pipeline contains no active opportunities. Twelve rows remain active. Excluding closed outcomes must not exclude the Prospect, Qualify and Discover records.

Worked review

A strength supported by the snapshot: Twelve active opportunities provide coverage across Prospect, Qualify and Discover.

A risk supported by the snapshot: B-002 combines the largest active value with unusually long qualification time and needs investigation.

Your pipeline review

Keep the four evidence reviews, whether you checked selections or viewed a worked review, and your optional interpretations. The interaction downloads these details as an Excel workbook named my-pipeline-review.xlsx. Open it in Excel or another compatible spreadsheet application. It contains your completed selections, checked or worked-answer status, and optional interpretations. Long notes continue on additional rows. Save it before reloading. Excel edits do not update the activity. The complete text version and PDF provide the same data and feedback without the interaction or a spreadsheet application.

Complete each field before checking. Use the data controls to inspect the records. Complete all four evidence reviews before opening your final record. If an answer changes, check it again before completing that review. This review is not complete yet remains visible for an incomplete review.

Use your evidence review to decide what you would investigate next. Return to the course page to mark this step complete; the workbench does not update FutureLearn completion.